

Boston Sunday Globe

Serving our community since 1872

AUGUST 24, 2025

Battered by floods, imperiled by US cuts

Vacancies at Weather Service unnerve rural area

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

JACKSON, Ky. — Everyone who lived through the floods still remembers exactly where the waters crested.

Up to the roof of a friend's home. Lapping the front doors of offices and businesses. Submerging precious historical archives.

Over one night in July 2022, torrential rains deluged several counties deep in the mountains of eastern Kentucky, causing flash floods that raised rivers to record-breaking levels. Ultimately, 44 people died and hundreds of homes, businesses, and other structures were destroyed or severely damaged.

As bad as it was, many local officials and leaders believe it could have been much worse without the help of the local office of the National Weather Service, or NWS. Situated outside the town of Jackson atop a 1,300-foot hill, the office issued flash flood warnings "constant-

KENTUCKY, Page A13

Attacks on Smithsonian may obscure slavery story

By Murray Whyte
GLOBE STAFF

The lower level of the Smithsonian's National Museum of African American History and Culture is a somber feat of truth-telling. It begins with the origins of human bondage in the Americas with the Portuguese, who transformed a forced-labor economy in North Africa in the 15th century into a brisk international enslavement trade, and then, with the discovery of the American continents, a vast global industry of cruelty-generated wealth.

It does this compellingly, movingly, through images and objects tied to the experiences of enslaved people, from centuries-old leg and neck shackles used on slave ships to the clothing and sacred objects they would hold close throughout their generational ordeal.

MUSEUMS, Page A12

'It's important for us to really double down on our commitment to science and evidence-based recommendations.'

ROBBIE GOLDSTEIN, Massachusetts' public health commissioner

States counter health guidance

Mass. among group considering ways to supplant RFK Jr.'s policies

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

A gathering in Providence of public health officials from eight states this past week could lead to a new regional collaboration

positioned to supplant the Trump administration's oversight of some major public health services.

Massachusetts health officials had already discussed the

possibility of coordinating vaccine recommendations with neighboring states, rather than relying on federal health agencies for guidance. But in the wake of the meeting in Providence, officials said, participating states also considered how they could work collectively to maintain effective disease track-

ing and emergency response services in the face of the Trump administration's damaging funding cuts and changing health priorities.

The tools needed to prevent and monitor infectious diseases are on the minds of local public health officials as respiratory vi-

PUBLIC HEALTH, Page A11

TWO COUNTRIES, an extended community, and the hardening line between them



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

By Mark Arsenault
GLOBE STAFF

The main event of the annual friendship festival between the towns of Calais, Maine, and St. Stephen, New Brunswick, is the parade across the US-Canada border. It's a winding thread of homemade floats and howling fire engines that denotes how intimately these communities are stitched together.

But this summer, the 52nd year of the festival, it almost didn't happen. St. Stephen officials even voted to cancel their side of the parade due to a lack of entries, before the reality that the tradition might die inspired a last-minute rally. The saved procession, on Aug. 9, inched through Calais and crossed into Canada over the languid St. Croix River, at a spot where the river narrows and the two towns, and two nations, are just a long fly ball apart.

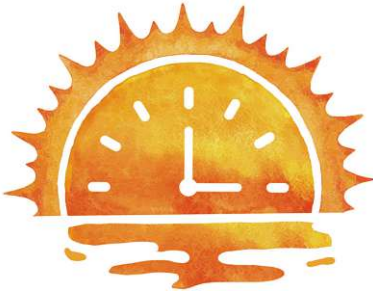
The international border between Calais and St. Stephen was once little more than a formality between towns entwined by generations of marriage, history, and economics. Now, their relationship is

BORDER, Page A14



The annual parade in Calais, Maine, and St. Stephen, New Brunswick, was almost canceled because of tensions between the US and Canada. Yet, on Aug. 9, town residents, including a cheer squad, joined to celebrate their heritage.

Summer's on its way out?
Not until you take a shot at these sunny opportunities. **Travel, N11.**



Rhode Island officials denounced the Trump administration's decision to halt construction on a \$4 billion wind farm that is 80 percent complete. **B1.**

Make it three straight for the Sox over the Yankees, as pitcher Garrett Crochet dominated again, 12-1. **C1.**

After a group reported famine in parts of the Gaza Strip, criticism of Israel was nearly universal, except for the United States. **A2.**

Far-right groups say there's not much left to protest as the Trump administration adopts its positions. **A9.**

A timid sol

Sunday: Sun/clouds, breezy. High 79-84, low 65-70.
Monday: Possible storm. High 76-81, low 62-67.
Complete report, **A22.**
Obituaries, **A19.**

VOL. 308, NO. 55

Suggested retail price
\$6.00



Short Term. Strong Return.

4.00% APY*
10-MONTH CD

AVAILABLE FOR PERSONAL ACCOUNTS

Open at any of our 13 offices or visit
institutionforsavings.com for more info!



INSTITUTION FOR SAVINGS

BUILDING STRONGER COMMUNITIES TOGETHER SINCE 1820.

978-462-3106 • institutionforsavings.com

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is effective 8/21/25. Term deposit rates and APYs are fixed for the duration of the term. Maximum deposit per primary account owner is \$250,000. Minimum balance to open an account and obtain the Annual Percentage Yield shown is \$500. A penalty will be imposed for early withdrawal. Account is available for personal accounts only. Rate is subject to change. Deposits insured in full. Account holder must be present to open. Member FDIC Member DIF • Equal Housing Lender